

Chapter 166-3

After a moment, Liang Shi got straight to the point. "Go ahead and say it. What do you want to tell me? You didn't just want to go shooting with me, did you?"

Lu Jiayi snapped her fingers. "It's nice dealing with smart people."

"Don't." Liang Shi stopped her. "I'm not your business partner. You don't need to butter me up."

"You could always whisper in her ear at night." Lu Jiayi teased ambiguously.

Liang Shi was momentarily at a loss for words.

But Lu Jiayi restrained her smile and became more serious before getting to the point. "I had a question I wanted to ask before, but now I feel like I've caught a glimpse of the answer. Still, I want to ask it directly."

Liang Shi: "...Go ahead."

"You seem to really dislike me." Lu Jiayi said, "Ever since we first met. Can I ask why?"

She was very sincere—from her tone to her smile, everything was impeccable.

Most people seeing her like this would probably think they themselves had done something wrong to cause the current situation.

But Liang Shi stared at her for a while, then suddenly said, "Because you're too perfect."

Lu Jiayi's expression froze for a few seconds. Before she could squeeze out a smile, she heard Liang Shi continue, "You can do everything, and you do everything well. You're like a... mannequin. Too deliberate."

Lu Jiayi paused, somewhat at a loss for words.

She didn't know how to respond.

After a while, she finally said, "But in my view, Xu Qingzhu is also very perfect. She has no flaws, doesn't she?"

"She does," Liang Shi said.

Lu Jiayi: "?"

Liang Shi paused. "She can't cook, and her personality is a bit dull."

Lu Jiayi shook her head. "Those don't count as flaws."

"But you don't even have these flaws that don't count as flaws." Liang Shi said, "You seem to be able to do everything, always scheming and strategizing. I don't like people like you, because when I'm too close to you, I feel like I'm just a piece on your chessboard."

Lu Jiayi: "..."

After a long while, Lu Jiayi suddenly laughed, chuckling softly. "You're right."

"But whether I like you or not isn't important." Liang Shi said, "Have you never been disliked by anyone your whole life? Why do you need to find an answer from someone? Besides, I'm only unfriendly toward you—it hasn't reached the level of dislike."

Lu Jiayi replied, "Because I greatly admire my business partner. The people she values, I will also value."

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi truly didn't understand the ways of business, but faced with Lu Jiayi's attitude, she didn't know whether to praise her professionalism or think this person was fake.

Lu Jiayi didn't take it to heart and explained on her own, "I guessed you were angry because I rescued Xu Qingzhu before you did, but I didn't expect the real reason to be this."

Liang Shi: "...Am I being petty?"

Lu Jiayi shook her head. "I admire you."

Liang Shi didn't understand. "Why?"

"You're very sincere." Lu Jiayi said, "It's been a long time since anyone has spoken to me like this. Although it sounds annoying, it's... the truth."

Liang Shi lightly pressed her lips together, then suddenly asked, "Don't you get tired of living with a mask on all the time?"

Lu Jiayi's expression shifted slightly, then she put on that faint smile again and changed the subject. "I'm getting engaged, so I need to go back to the capital tomorrow. Please pass a message to Xu Qingzhu for me—I'll be gone for about a week."

"Engaged?!" Liang Shi was shocked.

"What?" Lu Jiayi asked. "Only you two can get married early, but I can't get engaged?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"This is so sudden," Liang Shi said.

Lu Jiayi pressed her lips together. "It's arranged by my family. I expect... life won't be peaceful afterward."

"Then... will you still come back?" Liang Shi asked.

Lu Jiayi nodded. "Of course. After the engagement, I'll handle some things in the capital and then come back."

"I wish you well."

"Thank you."

As they were about to leave, Liang Shi suddenly asked, "So what kind of person is your fiancée?"

Lu Jiayi pressed her temples. "I haven't met her yet. I'll tell you after I've seen her. But I've heard she's..."

She paused briefly, struggling to think of an appropriate adjective. "A knockoff Medusa."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi never expected that after the world timeline had been changed, Lu Jiayi's life had completely shifted direction.

And Lu Jiayi told her this not because she wanted to win more of her favor, but because she cared a great deal about Xu Qingzhu as a business partner. The engagement was the same.

For once, Lu Jiayi didn't hide anything and told Liang Shi directly, "I can tell you're jealous. So if my engagement can dispel your wariness and jealousy and allow my cooperation with Xu Qingzhu to proceed more smoothly, I'm happy to do it."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Why are you telling me this?" Liang Shi asked.

Lu Jiayi paused, then smiled. "Because your wife cares a lot about your feelings."

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This meeting changed Liang Shi's view of Lu Jiayi somewhat.

Only a little bit, though.

Still, the news of Lu Jiayi's engagement surprised her, but she could understand it afterward.

Liang Shi drove home. That evening, just as she was about to go out to pick up Xu Qingzhu, she received a call from Chen Mian.

It was noisy on Chen Mian's end. The heavy metal music was so loud it made Liang Shi's ears hurt, and she quickly held the phone away.

"What's wrong?" Liang Shi asked. "Where are you?"

"Four Colors Dusk." Chen Mian gave the name of a bar. "Come over."

Liang Shi asked, "Are you drunk?"

Chen Mian paused briefly. "It's not me. It's your sister."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Then take her to your place first, or somewhere safe. I'll come pick her up in about fifty minutes." Liang Shi said, "Is that okay?"

Most people wouldn't refuse such a request, so Liang Shi was about to hang up. But then she heard Chen Mian hesitate for two seconds on the other end: "No."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Do you have something to do?" Liang Shi said. "If that's the case, I'll go now..."

"No." Chen Mian said, "But I'm not suitable to be with her right now. I think... she needs you right now."

Liang Shi suddenly became alert. "What happened between you two? What's wrong with her?"

Chen Mian gave her an ultimatum. "You have twenty minutes."

Then she hung up.

Liang Shi: "..."